Laguna State Polytechnic University
ITST 306 UX/UI and Cross Platform

Laboratory Activity No. 6

Critical Review of an Accessibility Resource
Topic 6: Accessibility and Inclusivity (Weeks 11 and 12)

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Section:	BSIT – 4D	**Score:**	/ 50

Objectives

After completing this activity, you should be able to: (1) summarize the main ideas of an accessibility video or paper in your own words; (2) connect the content to WCAG levels and the four POUR principles; (3) judge the quality and usefulness of the resource; and (4) test one technique from the resource on a real website or app.

Instructions

Choose **one** video or paper about web or app accessibility. Good choices are an episode of *A11ycasts* by Rob Dodson on the Chrome for Developers YouTube channel, a video or article from the W3C Web Accessibility Initiative (w3.org/WAI), an article from WebAIM (webaim.org), or a peer reviewed paper on accessible interface design. A video should run at least 8 minutes and a paper should be at least 4 pages. Get your instructor's approval if you choose another source. Write every answer in your own words. Copied or machine generated text will receive no credit.

Part A. Resource Information (4 points)

Title	ACCESSIBILITY FUNDAMENTALS
Author or speaker	ROB DODSON
Publisher or channel	GOOGLE CHROME DEVELOPERS (YOUTUBE)
Year published	2018
Format and length	Video, minutes 28
Link or citation	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z8xUCzToff8

Part B. Summary (8 points)

Write 6 to 8 sentences that explain the main message of the resource and its most important points. Do not retell it from start to finish. State the main idea first.

The main message of this resource is that the accessibility of the Web depends on providing correct semantic information to support assistive technologies, in particular the accessibility tree in the browser. The speaker highlights the importance of considering accessibility from the outset of a project not only for legal reasons but also for the overall user experience. One of the important technologies is that browsers generate an accessibility tree from standard HTML, discarding non-semantic layout elements and retaining meaningful roles, names, states and values. Native HTML elements with built-in semantics and keyboard behaviors should always be used to create an interface, as they convey these semantics and behaviors by default. The video cautions against adding generic components such as without adequate enhancement, because they don't provide any meaning to a screen reader user. In these situations, the WAI-ARIA specification could be used to explicitly declare roles and states, but the roles themselves and the interaction with the keyboard should be explicitly coded by the developer as well. Last, it points to some current browser developer tools that enable developers to see the accessibility tree directly, and thus be able to more easily debug and ensure that semantic information is properly exposed.

Part C. Link to the Lesson (10 points)

For each POUR principle, mark whether your resource covers it. If it does, write a specific example, technique, or statement from the resource as evidence. If it does not, write "not covered" and say why you think it was left out. Each row is worth 2 points.

Principle	Covered	Evidence from the Resource
Perceivable	☐	The video explains how visual affordances are translated into text alternatives (like aria-label or aria-labelledby) so screen reader users can perceive the purpose and name of a control.
Operable	☐	The speaker notes that native elements have built-in keyboard support, and when creating custom widgets, developers must manually add expected keyboard behaviors (e.g., using the spacebar to toggle a custom checkbox).
Understandable	☐	It emphasizes the need to use clear, predictable labeling (such as using a heading and a button text together through the use of aria-labelledby), to help ensure that users know the context and purpose of interactive elements.
Robust	☐	The resource provides an explanation that Native HTML provides the greatest possible compatibility with current and future user agents, because standard elements are consistently translated into the accessibility tree by browsers, which assistive technology can use.

WCAG level the resource refers to (A, AA, AAA, or none): AA

Two of the 10 points are for this answer and its explanation. Add one short line below.

The video focuses on foundational techniques (semantic HTML, keyboard access, and proper labeling) that directly satisfy core WCAG 2.1 Level AA success criteria, which is the standard benchmark for practical and legal accessibility compliance.

Part D. Evaluation of the Resource (10 points)

Rate each item from 1 (poor) to 5 (excellent) by marking one circle, then justify your rating with a specific observation. Each row is worth 2 points. A rating with no justification earns 1 point.

Criterion	1	2	3	4	5	Justification
Accuracy	○	○	○	○	○	The explanation of the structure of the accessibility tree and the limitations on ARIA (only changing semantics, not behavior) is very correct, and it is right on target with the W3C standards.
Clarity	○	○	○	○	○	Complex concepts are made easy to grasp through relatable analogies, such as comparing UI affordances to everyday objects like a teapot or a door handle.
Practical examples	○	○	○	○	○	The live coding demonstration of how to make an unmodified into a complete accessible custom checkbox gives developers an easy-to-follow workflow.
Currency (is it up to date?)	○	○	○	○	○	The principles of HTML semantics and ARIA stay the same, but specific aspects of how developers use them have changed slightly since the video was produced in 2018.
Accessible itself (captions, text structure)	○	○	○	○	○	The content of the YouTube video is accurate, the captions are accurate, there is a clear transcript and the speaker speaks at a steady easy to follow pace when talking about the technical concepts.

Part E. Put It to the Test (8 points)

Choose one technique, tip, or finding from the resource. Test it on a real website or app, such as the university portal or a site you use every day. Record what you did and what you found.

Technique tested	Keyboard-only navigation and focus indicator visibility.
Website or app	Wikipedia (en.wikipedia.org)
Tool or method used	Keyboard only (Tab, Shift+Tab, Enter, Space)

Steps taken	1. Opened the Wikipedia homepage. 2. Pressed the 'Tab' key repeatedly to navigate through interactive elements like the search bar, "Read", "View source", and sidebar links. 3. Observed the visual focus indicator (the black outline) around each element. 4. Pressed 'Enter' to activate the search bar, typed a query, and pressed 'Enter' again to submit.
Result observed	The focus indicator was clearly visible on all interactive elements. The logical tab order perfectly matched the visual layout of the page, moving smoothly from the top navigation to the main content and then to the sidebar.
Did the site pass?	Pass ☐ Partly ☐ Fail ☐

Attach one screenshot or a short description of your evidence on the back of this sheet.

Upon pressing 'Tab', a distinct, high-contrast black outline appeared around the "Main page" link, then the "Contents" link, and subsequently the search input field. No interactive elements were skipped, and the focus never became trapped or invisible.

Part F. Critical Response (10 points)

1. What are the two strongest points of the resource, and why do they work? (3 points)

First, the clear explanation of the accessibility tree removes the mystery between browsers and screen readers, getting the developer's thinking out of the dark and into the light. Secondly, the "use native HTML elements first" rule is very strong and very actionable, because it is simple enough that it can serve as a heuristic to avoid unnecessary complexity and avoid common bugs before they even begin.

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2. What is missing, unclear, or weak? Give at least one real limitation. (3 points)

One of the drawbacks of the video is that it doesn't go in-depth on keyboard accessibility, just briefly mentions it, and it doesn't go deep into complex focus management scenarios. It doesn't include examples of how to capture focus inside a modal dialog, how to handle focus when there are dynamically added elements (such as routing in a single-page app), which are very common in the real world for developers.

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3. Would you recommend this resource to a classmate? Explain how it would change the way you design your own interfaces. (4 points)

Yes, I would highly recommend this resource to my classmate, especially those who are new to accessibility. It would make me more likely to use semantic elements over heavily styled elements when designing my own interfaces, <button>, <nav> and <main> would be my go-to elements. Also, it would give me a reminder to always check the accessibility tree and ensure that any semantic information is properly exposed before taking a component for granted that is accessible.

Scoring Guide

The instructor will use this guide. Points are given for specific, accurate, and original work.

Part	Full Credit Looks Like	Points	Score
A. Resource Information	All fields complete and the source can be found from the citation.	4	
B. Summary	Clear main idea, accurate key points, own words, no retelling, within length.	8	
C. Link to the Lesson	Correct use of POUR and WCAG with concrete evidence from the resource.	10	
D. Evaluation	Ratings are backed by specific observations, not general opinions.	10	

E. Put It to the Test	A real test, clear steps, an honest result, and evidence attached.	8	
F. Critical Response	Balanced strengths and limits, with a personal and practical conclusion.	10	
Total		**50**	

Instructor comments